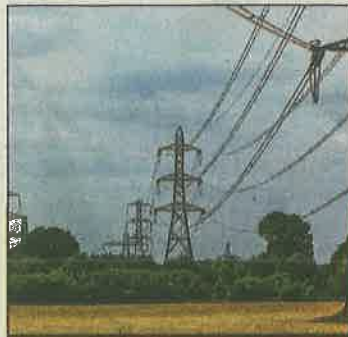




CESC BOARD APPROVES RAISING ₹250CR VIA SECURED, UNLISTED NCDS ON PVT PLACEMENT BASIS

VEDANTA IRON & STEEL REVENUE JUMPS 18% YEAR-ON-YEAR IN Q1 TO ₹3,662 CRORE

The implementation of Centre's PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana is emerging as a key catalyst for the growth of Bengal's solar industry, prompting manufacturers, dealers and allied businesses to expand operations in anticipation of rising demand

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Solar cell and panel manufacturers, whose businesses were largely dependent on projects in other states over the past few years, are now witnessing growing opportunities in their home market. Demand from both residential and commercial consumers is encouraging companies to scale up production and strengthen distribution networks across the state.

The momentum comes as the Bengal govt pursues an ambitious renewable energy roadmap, targeting nearly 20% of the state's electricity generation from renewable sources by 2030, a sharp increase from current levels. Industry estimates peg Bengal's solar market at around Rs 10,000 crore.

The expected expansion is also likely to benefit local MSMEs manufacturing components required for solar installations. Industry experts said several leading companies have started partnering with smaller enterprises for local sourcing, creating fresh opportunities across the supply chain.

According to industry stakeholders, Bengal has the potential to emerge as one of India's leading solar energy hubs. Over the next five years, the sector is expected to witness accelerated adoption of rooftop solar systems across households, offices and commercial establishments. Growth is also likely to come from solar-powered irri-

SUNSHINE ECONOMY



gation pumps, street lighting projects in urban and rural areas, and wider deployment of decentralised renewable energy solutions.

Companies are simultaneously focusing on strengthening grid infrastructure, promoting net metering and increasing consumer awareness to support higher solar adoption. While experts do not expect solar energy to replace conventional power in the immediate future, they foresee a balanced energy mix where solar, supported by battery storage, smart grids and other renewable technologies, gradually reduces dependence on fossil fuels.

Industry leaders also stressed the need for supportive policies to unlock the sector's full potential. They believe the opportunity extends beyond electricity generation, encompassing rural development, MSME growth, employment generation and climate resilience.

"Every decentralised solar project is an investment not only in clean energy, but also in economic opportunity and sustainable development," industry stakeholders observed.

Having built its presence in Bengal over nearly two decades, Vikram Solar Ltd believes the state is well positioned to become a clean energy manufacturing and consumption hub.

Gyanesh Chaudhary, chairman and managing director of Vikram Solar Ltd, said, "While the East built its industrial legacy on coal and

heavy industry, we believe its future will be written in clean energy, and steps like the state's 2026-27 budget commitment of Rs 100 crore for two lakh rooftop solar systems show that shift is already gathering pace. Reliable green energy is fast becoming the deciding factor for new-age industries such as AI data centres, green steel and green cement. Bengal has a genuine opportunity to be that destination."

Alongside utility-scale projects, rooftop solar installations across residential, commercial and industrial segments are expected to gather pace, supported by solar-powered agriculture and govt initiatives such as the PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana.

Alok Garodia, chairman and managing director of Jupiter International Ltd, said sustained investments in transmission infrastructure, energy storage and grid modernisation would be essential to seamlessly integrate renewable energy into the power network.

"Bengal is our home state and our association goes back over five decades. We continue to closely monitor opportunities across the country as we evaluate our long-term manufacturing and business expansion strategy. As our growth journey progresses, we will continue to evaluate opportunities across different states, including Bengal, based on factors such as infrastructure, policy support, availability of skilled talent and long-term business viability. As a manufacturer, we believe that continued investment in next-generation technologies and strengthening the country's domestic solar manufacturing ecosystem will be essential to support this transition," said Garodia.

Industry participants believe advances in energy storage and improvements in grid infrastructure will further accelerate solar adoption.

Samprati Kamdar, director of Samvik Power Pvt Ltd, said, "As storage technologies become more affordable and grid infrastructure improves, solar's contribution will continue to grow rapidly. The future is not about replacing conventional power overnight — it is about creating a cleaner, more resilient and sustainable energy ecosystem where renewable energy plays the leading role."

Highlighting the company's growing presence in Bengal, Kamdar added, "We have already sold solar kits to more than 200 houses in Bengal in the last two months. Our vision is to make clean energy accessible, reliable and commercially viable for every customer. As a fully integrated EPC company, we provide end-to-end solutions—from system design and engineering to procurement, installation, commissioning, and long-term operation and

maintenance. We are actively delivering rooftop solar projects, industrial and commercial installations, solar water pumping systems, solar street lighting, and hybrid energy solutions across Bengal and beyond."

Industry experts believe Bengal is well placed to emerge as eastern India's leading decentralised renewable energy market.

Anuj Jalan, managing director of Tandhan, said, "The solar energy sector in Bengal has strong growth potential, driven particularly by low costs and large resources waiting to be drawn on, especially in areas such as rooftop, floating, and ground-mounted solar. That said, investments into the sector have to keep pace with the segment's growth trends as reflected by the northward-bound solar energy generation graph."

Rohit Bagrecha, managing director of RR Solar Power Projects, believes the next phase of growth will be driven not only by large solar parks but also by decentralised solutions that directly benefit communities.

"Our company is helping bring renewable energy closer to farms, businesses and underserved communities. It is also developing turnkey applications involving small wind turbine systems and solar-powered EV infrastructure, reflecting the next generation of integrated clean-energy solutions. Over the next five years, the state's solar growth is expected to be driven by rooftop installations, solar-powered agriculture, rural infrastructure and decentralised renewable energy (DRE) solutions," said Bagrecha.

He went on to add that solar-powered cold storage facilities, food processing units, drinking water systems, street lighting and clean mobility solutions could reduce post-harvest losses, strengthen rural enterprises and improve quality of life, reinforcing solar energy's role as a key pillar of Bengal's sustainable economic growth.



20% Bengal govt is targeting to source 20% of its electricity from renewable sources by 2030

₹10,000cr Solar market in Bengal

₹100cr State's 2026-27 budget proposed for 2 lakh rooftop solar systems

INDUSTRY SPEAK

While the East built its legacy on coal, green energy is its future. Renewable energy is fast becoming the deciding factor for AI data centres, green steel and green cement

Gyanesh Chaudhary | CMD, VIKRAM SOLAR

As our growth journey progresses, we will continue to evaluate opportunities across different states, including Bengal, based on factors such as infrastructure, policy support, availability of skilled talent and long-term business viability

Alok Garodia | CMD, JUPITER INTERNATIONAL LTD

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Samprati Kamdar | DIRECTOR, SAMVIK POWER PVT LTD

The solar energy sector in Bengal has strong growth potential, driven particularly by low costs and large resources waiting to be drawn on. Rooftop, floating, and ground-mounted solar panels will be the easiest sources of energy as the sector develops in the state

Anuj Jalan | MANAGING DIRECTOR, TANDHAN

Over the next five years, the state's solar growth is expected to be driven by rooftop installations, solar-powered agriculture, rural infrastructure and decentralised renewable energy (DRE) solutions

Rohit Bagrecha | MD, RR SOLAR POWER PROJECTS